Publishing a Windows release

Pushing a v* tag runs the Release workflow on GitHub. It checks formatting, runs Clippy and the tests, builds the MSVC executable, runs the UI smoke test, and publishes a ZIP and its SHA-256 checksum as a GitHub Release. A failed check publishes nothing.

Release steps

1. **Bump the version** in Cargo.toml, then update Cargo.lock:
2. cargo update -p sentinel-ssh --offline

Use a suffix such as 0.2.0-rc.1 for a pre-release. It is labelled Pre-release and is not marked Latest.

3. **Commit and push** the release commit. Make sure your working tree is clean.
4. **Do a test run** (recommended): open **Actions → Release → Run workflow** on your branch. This builds and checks everything and uploads the ZIP as an Actions artifact, but does not publish anything.
5. **Tag and push.** The tag must be v plus the exact Cargo version, or the workflow stops.
6. git tag -a v0.1.0 -m "SentinelSSH v0.1.0"
7. git push origin v0.1.0
8. **Watch Actions → Release** until both jobs pass.
9. **Check the release** on the Releases page. It should have these assets:
    - sentinel-ssh-<version>-windows-x64.zip
    - sentinel-ssh-<version>-windows-x64.zip.sha256

If something fails

- **Build failed:** fix it in a new commit and release under a new version. Don't move a tag after it has been published.
- **Only the publish job failed** and no release was created: re-run the failed jobs.
- **Release already exists:** the workflow never overwrites it. Delete it on GitHub first if you really need to re-publish.

Build a ZIP locally

MSVC build (needs the Visual Studio C++ tools)

cargo build --release --locked --target x86_64-pc-windows-msvc

.\scripts\package-release.ps1 -Version 0.1.0

Portable GNU/LLVM build from scripts\dev.ps1

.\scripts\package-release.ps1 -Version 0.1.0 -Executable .\target\slint\release\sentinel-ssh.exe

The output goes to target\release-assets. The ZIP contains only the executable, README, license, and threat model.

Update the application icon

1. Edit assets/icon/sentinel-ssh.svg (32 px and larger) or sentinel-ssh-small.svg (16–24 px).
2. Regenerate the .ico with GIMP 3. Add -PreviewDirectory <folder> to save a PNG of each size for review.
3. .\scripts\build-icon.ps1
4. Commit the updated .ico. build.rs embeds it in the executable.

Notes

- If PowerShell blocks the scripts, run them as powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File <script> ....
- Users download the ZIP from **Assets**. GitHub's **Source code** archives do not contain the executable.
- Releases from a private repository can only be downloaded by people with access to it.
- To check a download, compare Get-FileHash <zip> -Algorithm SHA256 with the first value in the .sha256 file.
- The executable is unsigned, and there is no installer or auto-updater yet. The open security gates are listed in the threat model.